

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY

COURSE SUMMARY

Business Freelancing

What You Will Learn in Every Session

9 SESSIONS

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Business Freelancing — Course Summary

A quick reference of what is covered and what you will learn in each session.

QUICK NAVIGATION

Session 01 — Business Freelancing Foundations

Session 02 — Finding Your Market and Validating an Idea

Session 03 — Registration Legal and Money Basics

Session 04 — Pricing Your Work and Costing

Session 05 — Finding Your First Customers and Selling

Session 06 — Customer Service and Managing Clients

Session 07 — Invoicing Getting Paid and Basic Accounting

Session 08 — Digital Presence and Marketing for Small Business

Session 09 — Capstone Your Business and Freelance Plan

SESSION 01

Business Freelancing Foundations

Week 1 â€" Module 1: Start Right (Foundations)

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ **Define** — what a business is in their own words and explain why the definition includes a pure oga who sells recharge card and a freelance writer equally.
- ✓ **Distinguish** — between the three routes to income â€" **freelancing**, **service business** and **product business** â€" and give a Nigerian example of each, including a hybrid.
- ✓ **Describe** — the trade-offs of each route in terms of capital needed, speed to first naira, risk and control, and say which route fits their own situation.
- ✓ **Explain** — the entrepreneur mindset: responsibility, action before perfect conditions, handling "no", following up and patience â€" with a real-life story for each.
- ✓ **Name** — at least three opportunities and three constraints in the Nigerian environment that affect a small business.
- ✓ **Complete** — a personal skill inventory of at least five marketable skills and draft a first **Offer Sheet**: who the customer is, the problem, the deliverable and a realistic starting price range in naira.
- ✓ **Score at least 70%** — on the Session 1 knowledge check (LO1).

SESSION 02

Finding Your Market and Validating an Idea

Week 1 â€" Module 1: Start Right (Foundations)

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ **Write** — a clear customer-problem statement in one sentence and describe a specific target customer.
- ✓ **Narrow** — "everybody" into a niche and explain why a niche is easier to serve and to find.
- ✓ **Describe** — at least four free market research methods: market walks, competitor price checks, online search (Google, Jiji, Facebook, WhatsApp status) and respectful listening in WhatsApp groups.
- ✓ **Ask** — five open questions in a customer conversation, listen more than they talk, and record answers honestly â€" not as they hoped.
- ✓ **Complete** — a competitor price scan with at least five real observed prices and their sources.
- ✓ **Apply** — a simple decision rule â€" problem real? skill adequate? willingness to pay? competition survivable? â€" to make a reasoned **go / adjust / stop** decision.
- ✓ **Produce** — a Validation Notes sheet with three recorded customer conversations and a competitor scan (LO3, LO4).

SESSION 03

Registration Legal and Money Basics

Week 1 â€" Module 1: Start Right (Foundations)

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ **Explain** — what CAC registration does and the difference between a **business name** and a **limited company**.
- ✓ **Outline** — the broad steps of CAC registration and state where to check current requirements and fees (cac.gov.ng) â€" never from memory or a roadside agent.
- ✓ **Explain** — what a **TIN** is, why clients and banks ask for it, and where to get one.
- ✓ **Explain** — why a **separate business bank account** matters and describe at least two practical money separation methods (two accounts, or an envelope system).
- ✓ **Name** — at least two permits or regulators that may apply to specific businesses (e.g., local government, NAFDAC for food) and state where to confirm them.
- ✓ **Set up** — a basic record-keeping sheet (daily sales and daily expenses) and make three example entries.
- ✓ **Score at least 70%** — on the Session 3 knowledge check (LO5).

SESSION 04

Pricing Your Work and Costing

Week 2 â€" Module 2: Win and Price Clients

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ **Calculate** — the full cost of a job, including materials, data, transport, tools, packaging, overhead share, waste allowance and their own time.
- ✓ **Choose** — a pricing model â€" per hour, per job/day, or package/retainer â€" and justify the choice with reasons.
- ✓ **Compute** — revenue, cost, profit and margin in naira.
- ✓ **Calculate** — break-even â€" how much sales value covers fixed costs.
- ✓ **Write** — a clear quote in naira: description, quantity, unit price, total, validity, payment terms and exclusions.
- ✓ **Produce** — a costed price list for three offers with break-even stated (LO6).
- ✓ **Score at least 70%** — on the Session 4 knowledge check.

SESSION 05

Finding Your First Customers and Selling

Week 2 â€" Module 2: Win and Price Clients

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ **Explain** — why most customers come from nearby â€" referrals, networking, word of mouth â€" and why these are cheaper than advertising.
- ✓ **Ask** — for referrals without begging, using a simple script.
- ✓ **Build** — a 60-second elevator pitch: who you serve, the problem, what you deliver, and what happens next.
- ✓ **Plan** — three referral/networking actions for the next week.
- ✓ **Role-play** — a full sales conversation: approach, ask, listen, propose, handle a price objection, agree a clear next step, and follow up.
- ✓ **Explain** — why most sales come on the second or third contact, and why silence is not always rejection.
- ✓ **Produce** — a written 60-second pitch script and a ten-name pipeline with planned approaches and follow-up dates (LO7).

SESSION 06

Customer Service and Managing Clients

Week 2 â€" Module 2: Win and Price Clients

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ **Apply** — four communication standards: reply fast, confirm in writing, use plain language, never leave a customer guessing.
- ✓ **Define** — scope â€" what is included, what is excluded â€" and explain why most "difficult client" stories are scope failures.
- ✓ **Set** — expectations in writing: price, timeline, update points, and what they need from the customer.
- ✓ **Write** — a one-page client agreement: parties, scope, price, timeline, payment schedule, cancellation, signatures.
- ✓ **Respond** — correctly to at least three difficult-client situations: scope creep, unrealistic deadline, late payment, complaint, and free-work-for-"exposure".
- ✓ **Explain** — when to walk away from a client professionally.
- ✓ **Score at least 70%** — on the Session 6 knowledge check (LO8).

SESSION 07

Invoicing Getting Paid and Basic Accounting

Week 3 â€" Module 3: Run and Grow

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ **Distinguish** — between a quote, an invoice and a receipt â€" and explain when each is used.
- ✓ **Produce** — a complete invoice: business name, date, invoice number, customer, description, quantity, unit price, total, payment details and terms.
- ✓ **Set up** — an income and expense tracker in Google Sheets and record transactions correctly.
- ✓ **Follow** — a polite payment-chasing sequence: friendly reminder on due date, follow-up call, firm written message with the invoice attached, documented escalation.
- ✓ **Explain** — in simple terms the taxes a small Nigerian business must consider (income tax, withholding tax, VAT awareness) and why to check current rules on official FIRS/state sources.
- ✓ **Develop** — the habit of setting aside a fixed percentage of every payment for tax.
- ✓ **Raise** — a complete invoice and start a working tracker (LO9).

SESSION 08

Digital Presence and Marketing for Small Business

Week 3 â€" Module 3: Run and Grow

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ **Explain** — why being found online matters for a small business â€" and why it can be free.
- ✓ **Set up** — a complete WhatsApp Business profile: profile photo or logo, clear description, business hours, catalogue of at least three items, greeting message, customer labels and broadcast lists.
- ✓ **Describe** — the steps to create a Google Business Profile â€" and why "near me" searches matter.
- ✓ **Choose** — one social platform to maintain well â€" and explain why one platform done well beats five done poorly.
- ✓ **Plan** — seven days of free marketing: real photos, prices, before/after, customer feedback, availability.
- ✓ **Apply** — trust-building principles: consistent name and logo, fast replies, honest descriptions, no fake testimonials.
- ✓ **Produce** — a complete WhatsApp Business profile and a seven-day free marketing plan (LO10).

SESSION 09

Capstone Your Business and Freelance Plan

Week 3 â€" Module 3: Run and Grow

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ **Assemble** — a one-page business and freelance plan from the artefacts produced in Sessions 1â€"8, with every section filled and internally consistent.
- ✓ **Build a simple financial snapshot** — â€" launch costs, monthly fixed costs, unit price, break-even and a first-month revenue target â€" with correct arithmetic in naira.
- ✓ **Deliver a 60-second pitch** — and a 3â€"4 minute talk that explains the plan, then **defend key decisions** (price, validation, break-even, first seven days) under questioning.
- ✓ **Check internal consistency** — across the plan, price list and financial snapshot so the numbers match everywhere they appear.
- ✓ **Give and receive structured peer feedback** — using a simple two-stars-and-a-wish format.
- ✓ **State honest limits** — â€" three things the plan has not yet proven and what will be done next to test them.